

POPULATION AND ASSOCIATED ISSUES

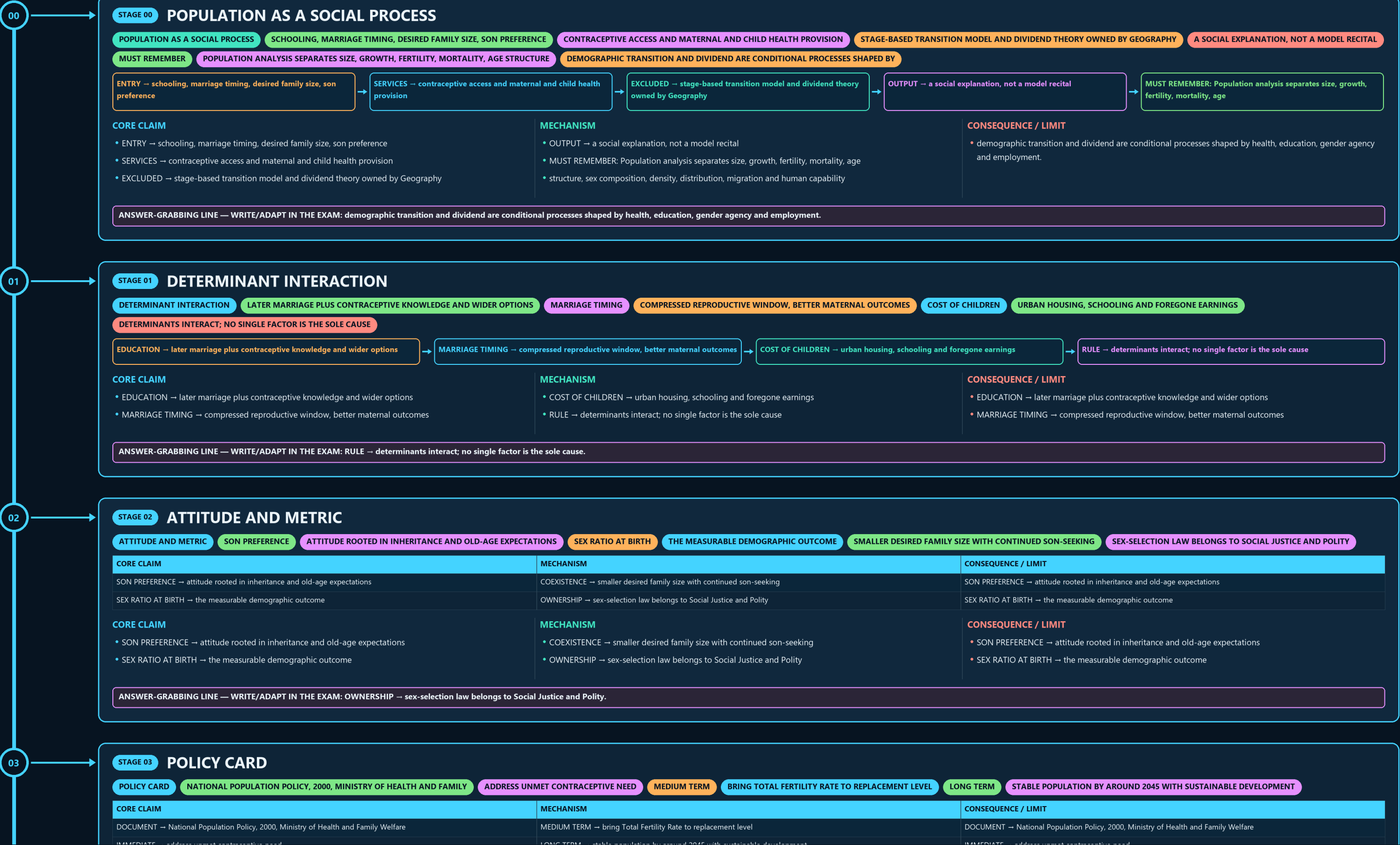
POPULATION AS A SOCIAL → DETERMINANT INTERACTION → ATTITUDE AND METRIC → POLICY CARD → EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER → AGGREGATE AGAINST DIVERGENCE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

SON PREFERENCE → attitude rooted in inheritance and old-age expectations

SEX RATIO AT BIRTH → the measurable demographic outcome

COEXISTENCE → smaller desired family size with continued son-seeking

OWNERSHIP → sex-selection law belongs to Social Justice and Polity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OWNERSHIP → sex-selection law belongs to Social Justice and Polity.

04

STAGE 03

POLICY CARD

POLICY CARD

NATIONAL POPULATION POLICY, 2000, MINISTRY OF HEALTH AND FAMILY

ADDRESS UNMET CONTRACEPTIVE NEED

MEDIUM TERM

BRING TOTAL FERTILITY RATE TO REPLACEMENT LEVEL

LONG TERM

STABLE POPULATION BY AROUND 2045 WITH SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare	MEDIUM TERM → bring Total Fertility Rate to replacement level	DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need	LONG TERM → stable population by around 2045 with sustainable development	IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need
CORE CLAIM - DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare - IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need	MECHANISM - MEDIUM TERM → bring Total Fertility Rate to replacement level - LONG TERM → stable population by around 2045 with sustainable development	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare - IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LONG TERM → stable population by around 2045 with sustainable development.

05

STAGE 04

EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER

EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER

RELEASED 29 MAY 2026, TOTAL 2.0, URBAN 1.6, RURAL

2019-21 ROUND, TOTAL FERTILITY RATE 2.0, HISTORICAL COMPARATOR

2011 IS THE LAST COMPLETED FULL COUNT; CENSUS 2027

NO SURVEY AVERAGE MAY BE QUOTED AS A STATE

NFHS-5 → 2019-21 round, Total Fertility Rate 2.0, historical comparator

NFHS-6 → released 29 May 2026, total 2.0, urban 1.6, rural 2.1, provisional

CENSUS → 2011 is the last completed full count; Census 2027 is prospective

PROHIBITION → no survey average may be quoted as a state or current stock

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NFHS-6 → released 29 May 2026, total 2.0, urban 1.6, rural 2.1, provisional - NFHS-5 → 2019-21 round, Total Fertility Rate 2.0, historical comparator	- CENSUS → 2011 is the last completed full count; Census 2027 is prospective - PROHIBITION → no survey average may be quoted as a state or current stock	- NFHS-6 → released 29 May 2026, total 2.0, urban 1.6, rural 2.1, provisional - NFHS-5 → 2019-21 round, Total Fertility Rate 2.0, historical comparator

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PROHIBITION → no survey average may be quoted as a state or current stock.

06

STAGE 05

AGGREGATE AGAINST DIVERGENCE

AGGREGATE AGAINST DIVERGENCE

A WEIGHTED SUMMARY OF STATES IN DIFFERENT TRANSITION PHASES

BELOW REPLACEMENT

AGEING PRESSURE AND WORKFORCE-SHRINKAGE RISK

ABOVE REPLACEMENT

YOUNG STRUCTURE WITH AN OPEN DIVIDEND WINDOW

THE HONEST ANSWER IS STATE-GRADED, NOT NATION-UNIFORM

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases	ABOVE REPLACEMENT → young structure with an open dividend window	NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases
BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk	VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform	BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk
CORE CLAIM - NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases - BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk	MECHANISM - ABOVE REPLACEMENT → young structure with an open dividend window - VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases - BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform.

STAGE 06

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER

SUSTAINED SUB-REPLACEMENT FERTILITY WITH AGEING AND DECLINE

DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

LARGEST WORKING-AGE SHARE, GROWTH-FAVOURABLE WINDOW

NEAR-OPPOSITE PHASES OF THE SAME TRANSITION

A LARGE COUNTRY CAN DISPLAY BOTH ACROSS ITS REGIONS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline	RELATION → near-opposite phases of the same transition	DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline
DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window	CAUTION → a large country can display both across its regions	DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window

POPULATION AND ASSOCIATED ISSUES • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2552-5786 of 10890 • continues below

06

STAGE 06

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER

SUSTAINED SUB-REPLACEMENT FERTILITY WITH AGEING AND DECLINE

DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

LARGEST WORKING-AGE SHARE, GROWTH-FAVOURABLE WINDOW

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CORE CLAIM

• DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline

• DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window

MECHANISM

• RELATION → near-opposite phases of the same transition

• CAUTION → a large country can display both across its regions

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline

• DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → a large country can display both across its regions.

07

STAGE 07

AGEING DOUBLE READING

AGEING DOUBLE READING

LONGER LIFE FROM SUCCESSFUL MORTALITY AND HEALTH TRANSITION

RISING OLD-AGE DEPENDENCY AND WORKFORCE RECOMPOSITION

FAMILY-BASED CARE WEAKENED BY NUCLEARISATION

FORMAL OLD-AGE SECURITY NOT YET SCALED WHERE FERTILITY FELL

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition	SUPPORT → family-based care weakened by nuclearisation	ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition
BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition	GAP → formal old-age security not yet scaled where fertility fell earliest	BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition

CORE CLAIM

• ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition

• BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition

MECHANISM

• SUPPORT → family-based care weakened by nuclearisation

• GAP → formal old-age security not yet scaled where fertility fell earliest

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition

• BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GAP → formal old-age security not yet scaled where fertility fell earliest.

08

STAGE 08

TWO TRANSITION FRAMEWORKS

TWO TRANSITION FRAMEWORKS

FIRST TRANSITION

MORTALITY DECLINE FOLLOWED BY FERTILITY DECLINE

SECOND TRANSITION

VALUE AND FAMILY-FORMATION SHIFT BELOW REPLACEMENT

THE SECOND FRAMEWORK IS LARGELY EUROPEAN IN DERIVATION

AN ANALYTICAL LENS, NEVER AN ESTABLISHED INDIAN DIAGNOSIS

FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline

→

SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement

→

ORIGIN → the second framework is largely European in derivation

→

STATUS → an analytical lens, never an established Indian diagnosis

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline	ORIGIN → the second framework is largely European in derivation	FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline
SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement	STATUS → an analytical lens, never an established Indian diagnosis	SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement.

09

STAGE 09

MIGRATION OFFSET

MIGRATION OFFSET

RECEIVING REGION

WORKING-AGE INFLOW CUSHIONS WORKFORCE SHRINKAGE

SENDING REGION

ELDERLY PARENTS LEFT WITH THINNER HOUSEHOLD SUPPORT

NET EFFECT

THE AGEING PROBLEM IS REDISTRIBUTED, NOT REMOVED

ANSWER USE

RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage

→

SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support

→

NET EFFECT → the ageing problem is redistributed, not removed

→

ANSWER USE → state the regional trade-off before recommending mobility

→

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Population growth is not fertility, replacement fertility is not zero growth, density is

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage	ANSWER USE → state the regional trade-off before recommending mobility	survey flow, and demographic dividend is an opportunity rather than an automatic bonus.
SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Population growth is not fertility, replacement fertility is not zero growth, density is	
NET EFFECT → the ageing problem is redistributed, not removed	not pressure, sex ratio at birth is not overall sex ratio, Census stock is not	

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER USE → state the regional trade-off before recommending mobility.

POPULATION AND ASSOCIATED ISSUES • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 5104-8338 of 10890 • continues below

09

STAGE 09

MIGRATION OFFSET

MIGRATION OFFSET

RECEIVING REGION

WORKING-AGE INFLOW CUSHIONS WORKFORCE SHRINKAGE

SENDING REGION

ELDERLY PARENTS LEFT WITH THINNER HOUSEHOLD SUPPORT

NET EFFECT

THE AGEING PROBLEM IS REDISTRIBUTED, NOT REMOVED

ANSWER USE

RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage

SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support

NET EFFECT → the ageing problem is redistributed, not removed

ANSWER USE → state the regional trade-off before recommending mobility

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Population growth is not fertility, replacement fertility is not zero growth, density is

CORE CLAIM

MECHANISM

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage

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survey flow, and demographic dividend is an opportunity rather than an automatic bonus.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Population growth is not fertility, replacement fertility is not zero growth, density is not pressure, sex ratio at birth is not overall sex ratio, Census stock is not survey flow, and demographic dividend is an opportunity rather than an automatic bonus.

10

STAGE 10

POPULATION EDUCATION DESIGN

POPULATION EDUCATION DESIGN

AGE-APPROPRIATE, SCIENTIFIC AND RIGHTS-RESPECTING INSTRUCTION

HEALTH INFORMATION, GENDER EQUALITY, VOLUNTARY CHOICE, RESOURCE AWARENESS

SCHOOLS, COMMUNITY OUTREACH AND HEALTH SERVICES

CAPABILITY BUILDING, NEVER A DEMOGRAPHIC TARGET

EVIDENCE LIMIT

CENSUS 2011 IS THE LATEST COMPLETED CENSUS BASELINE AS

NFHS-5 AND PROJECTIONS HAVE DIFFERENT DATES AND METHODS; COMPARE

CONTENT → age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting instruction

OBJECTIVES → health information, gender equality, voluntary choice, resource awareness

DELIVERY → schools, community outreach and health services

SAFEGUARD → capability building, never a demographic target

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Census 2011 is the latest completed census baseline as of review, while SRS

CORE CLAIM

MECHANISM

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CONTENT → age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting instruction

OBJECTIVES → health information, gender equality, voluntary choice, resource awareness

DELIVERY → schools, community outreach and health services

SAFEGUARD → capability building, never a demographic target

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Census 2011 is the latest completed census baseline as of review, while SRS,

NFHS-5 and projections have different dates and methods; compare Kerala/Tamil Nadu ageing,

EAG-state youth and migration destinations without causal claims from state averages alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EAG-state youth and migration destinations without causal claims from state averages alone.

11

STAGE 11

POPULATION ANSWER SPINE

POPULATION ANSWER SPINE

DEFINE THE TERM PRECISELY AND NAME THE SOCIAL MECHANISM

DATED ANCHOR, THEN IMMEDIATE DISAGGREGATION BY STATE

AGEING PRESSURE AGAINST CONTINUING DIVIDEND CONDITIONS

GRADED VERDICT WITH THE SURVEY-VERSUS-CENSUS CAVEAT

OPEN → define the term precisely and name the social mechanism

BODY → dated anchor, then immediate disaggregation by state

TEST → ageing pressure against continuing dividend conditions

CLOSE → graded verdict with the survey-versus-census caveat

CORE CLAIM

MECHANISM

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

OPEN → define the term precisely and name the social mechanism

BODY → dated anchor, then immediate disaggregation by state

TEST → ageing pressure against continuing dividend conditions

CLOSE → graded verdict with the survey-versus-census caveat

OPEN → define the term precisely and name the social mechanism

BODY → dated anchor, then immediate disaggregation by state

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict with the survey-versus-census caveat.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

NATIONAL POPULATION POLICY, 2000 (CROSS-LINKED, NOT RESTATED IN MECHANISM)

STATE-SPECIFIC VARIATION

AGE STRUCTURE, FERTILITY AND ELDER-CARE CAPACITY VARY

BOUNDARY CASE 1 — LOCALISED DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER

A STATE WITH TFR MEANINGFULLY BELOW

BOUNDARY CASE 2 — CONTINUED DIVIDEND WINDOW

A STATE WITH TFR STILL ABOVE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

ADVANCED DEBATE

LEGACY / NUANCE

National Population Policy, 2000 (cross-linked, not restated in mechanism form):

CAUTION: State-specific variation: age structure, fertility and elder-care capacity vary

CAUTION: Boundary case 1 — localised demographic winter: a state with TFR meaningfully below

CAUTION: Boundary case 2 — continued dividend window: a state with TFR still above

CAUTION: Boundary case 3 — son-preference persistence amid falling family size: a household

CAUTION: Aggregate-versus-disaggregated-analysis trade-off: citing only the national TFR

CAUTION: Policy-lag trade-off: National Population Policy 2000's high-fertility-era framing

CAUTION: Migration-as-offset trade-off: using internal migration to offset regional

NFHS-5 (2019-21) recorded India's national TFR at 2.0, near replacement level. It is

National Population Policy, 2000 set immediate (unmet contraceptive need), medium-term

CAUTION: Sub-national fertility variation in India is substantial: several states are already

CAUTION: "Second demographic transition" theory is an analytical lens for value-linked

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.